

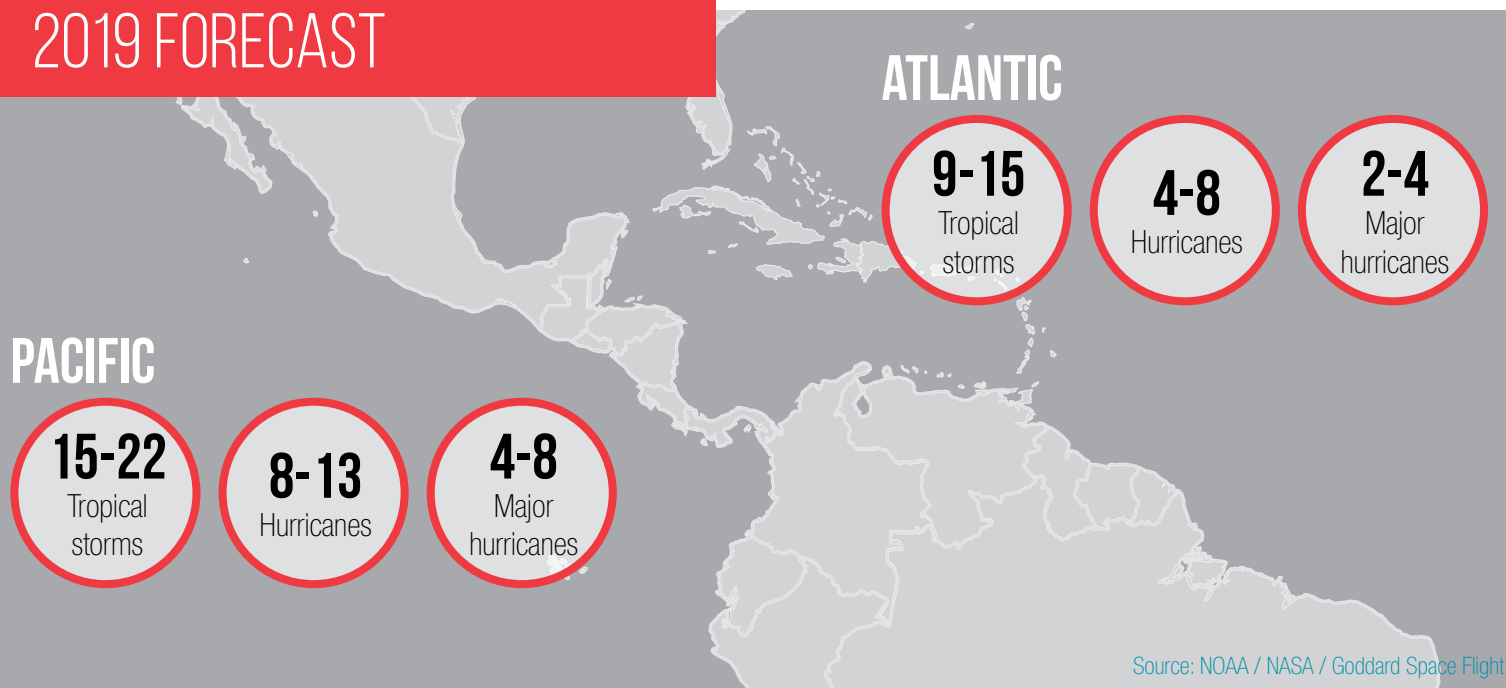
PREPAREDNESS FOR RESPONSE

HURRICANE SEASON 2019

Department of Disasters & Crises - IFRC
Regional Office for America



HURRICANE SEASON 2019 FORECAST



The hurricane season officially begins on May 15 in the Pacific Ocean and June 1 in the Atlantic Ocean, both ending on November 30.

HUMANITARIAN HUB

- Ability to respond simultaneously to two disasters and serve 7500 families in each emergency.
- Storage in a closed area of 4,800m², with a height of 8m.
- 2,200 m² open areas, for outdoor storage.
- Pre-positioned stock in Panama, Guatemala, Nicaragua and Honduras.
- Stock in-transit to be prepositioned in the National Societies of Bahamas, Barbados, Jamaica, Saint Lucia, Trinidad and Tobago and Dominican Republic.



This document is a summarized version of the Regional Hurricane Season Contingency Plan 2019.

PROCEDURE FOR THE DECLARATION OF ALERTS AND EMERGENCIES

Preventive alerts:

- **Alert I:** Beginning of the hurricane season.
- **Alert II:** When an event occurs, and it is necessary to take protective measures. It is issued before the formation of a storm or hurricane with probability of impact.
- **Alert III:** Impact, with minor or major effects, but no regional or global tools of the Red Cross are activated.

CATEGORIZATION OF EMERGENCIES AND CRISES

YELLOW CATEGORY

Localized impact in a small area and the National Society of the Red Cross (NS) requests support from the International Federation of the Red Cross (IFRC). DREF funds and/or human support are activated.

ORANGE CATEGORY

Broad impact with severe damage. NS requests support from the IFRC, an International Emergency Appeal (EA) is launched, national, regional and global tools are activated and mobilized.

RED CATEGORY

Broad impact, request for international assistance, NS requests assistance, an EA is launched, national, regional and global resources are mobilized.

POSSIBLE SCENARIOS

SCENARIO 1. Cyclonic event (storm or hurricane), does not directly impact the country. Minor collateral damage, the response is local and regional and/or global mechanisms are not activated.

Estimated minimum budget to respond to this scenario: **USD 10,000**

SCENARIO 2. Tropical storm with sustained winds greater than 63 Km/h. less than 5,000 affected families (25,000 people). Possible declaration of yellow category. Forecasts indicate that at least 9 storms of this type will develop in the Atlantic and 15 in the Pacific in 2019.

Estimated minimum budget to respond to this scenario: **USD 500,000**

SCENARIO 3. Major hurricane category 3; with sustained winds between 178/208 Km/h; Up to 40,000 affected families (200,000 people). Orange institutional category is declared. Forecasts indicate that at least 4 hurricanes of this intensity could occur in the Atlantic and 8 in the Pacific in 2019.

Minimum budget to respond to this scenario: **USD 7,000,000**

SCENARIO 4. Major hurricane category 4 or 5 with sustained winds greater than 209 km/h or more. High probability of impact in one or several countries. More than 200,000 families (1 million people) severely affected. Institutional orange or red category would be declared. The forecasts indicate between 2 and 4 major hurricanes with high destruction capacity in the Atlantic and between 4 and 8 in the Pacific in 2019.

Minimum budget to respond to this scenario: **USD 30,000,000**

CONTEXT IN AMERICA

- High-risk countries face internal sociopolitical crises that have diminished their resilience and response capacity in case of impact of a tropical storm or major hurricane.
- Underlying crisis or emergencies in countries with high risk of being impacted by hurricanes; which can increase the likelihood of major disasters in their territories.
- Migration crisis along the hurricane corridor increases the protection needs of people due to their high vulnerability.
- The current “weak” El Niño Phenomenon seems to persist in 2019. The average sea surface temperature in the tropical Atlantic is slightly below normal, and in the North Atlantic it is colder than normal.
- Security and safe access conditions will be key to humanitarian action where the NSs play an important role given their high acceptance in the most vulnerable communities within the hurricane corridor.

REGIONAL CAPACITIES FOR RESPONSE IN 2019 HURRICANE SEASON



800,000

Volunteers in the Americas

ENI

1,342

Volunteers trained as National
Intervention Teams

RIT

300

People are part of the Regional
Intervention Team

EDAN

2,242

Volunteers trained in Damage
Assessment and Needs Analysis



Regional Intervention Platform of
Americas and Caribbean, French Red
Cross based in Guadeloupe

CCST

5 Country Cluster Support Team based
in the Dominican Republic / Haiti,
Trinidad & Tobago, Honduras, Peru and
Argentina (see fig.1)

DM

5 regional disaster management
coordinators (Regional DM), more than
200 IFRC staff in the Americas, ready
and willing to support the response



Pre-positioned debit cards for the
delivery of cash-based interventions
to cover basic needs of the affected
population.

SCOPE AND COVERAGE OF THE PREPAREDNESS PLAN

- 35 National Societies in the Caribbean, Central America and South America. Branches of French RC (4), British RC (6), Dutch RC (6), American RC (2) (see fig.2).
- The Plan is activated from the beginning of the hurricane season in May 2019, until 15 days after the end of the season.

7 AREAS OF FOCUS

1. Disaster risk reduction
2. Shelter
3. Livelihoods
4. Health
5. Water, Sanitation and Hygiene Promotion
6. Protection, Gender and Inclusion
7. Migration

KEY ACTIONS FOR EFFECTIVE RESPONSE

1. Informative messages sent by the DMs 5 days before impact
2. Declaration of alerts and/or categories issued according to procedures, criteria and response capacity
3. Regional and global tools are activated according to alert and category
4. The regional EOC is activated and operates according to procedures and in the 4 pre-established coordination areas
5. DREF preparedness and response funds and International Emergency Appeal (EA) are approved in a period of between 24 and 72 hours
6. Surge personnel is mobilized in a period no longer than 72 hours after the request
7. Relief items mobilized in a period no longer than 5 days after impact
8. Key HR positions are published in a period no longer than 7 days after the approval of the EA
9. Update Reports are published as indicated by the procedures: 15 and 30 days, 6 and 12 months after the EA has been approved
10. The information management system works in an integral way with other departments and Partner National Societies (PNS)
11. Press releases, key messages and media management before, during and after the impact
12. Technical units provide technical and proactive support to the operation

GLOBAL CAPACITIES READY FOR RESPONSE DURING HURRICANE SEASON

ERU

Emergency Response Units in
Health, Logistics, Water, Sanitation,
etc.

FACT

Field Assessment and Coordination
Teams in the field

HEOps

Heads of Emergency Operations,
rapid mobilization, 24/7

RLU

5 Regional Logistics Units in the
world with emergency items (one
unit based in Panama)

EA

International Emergency Appeal

DREF

Disaster Relief Emergency Fund



Information Management Platform

<https://go.ifrc.org/regions/1>

INFORMATION MANAGEMENT FOR THE HURRICANE SEASON

For general operations information:

<https://www.goamericas.cruzroja.org/>

<https://go.ifrc.org/regions/1>

For information on Surge Capacity:

https://app.klipfolio.com/published/773cfe5e060090c4da83c35270b23a3c/dc_aro_surge

Information on regional readiness for the response:

https://app.klipfolio.com/published/9808ab2ac674f2ab31f593052297c50c/aro_ns_resources

FOCAL POINTS DURING THE HURRICANE SEASON

English speaking Caribbean and Suriname:

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REGIONAL DM



FIG. 1 **IFRC COUNTRY CLUSTER SUPPORT TEAMS**

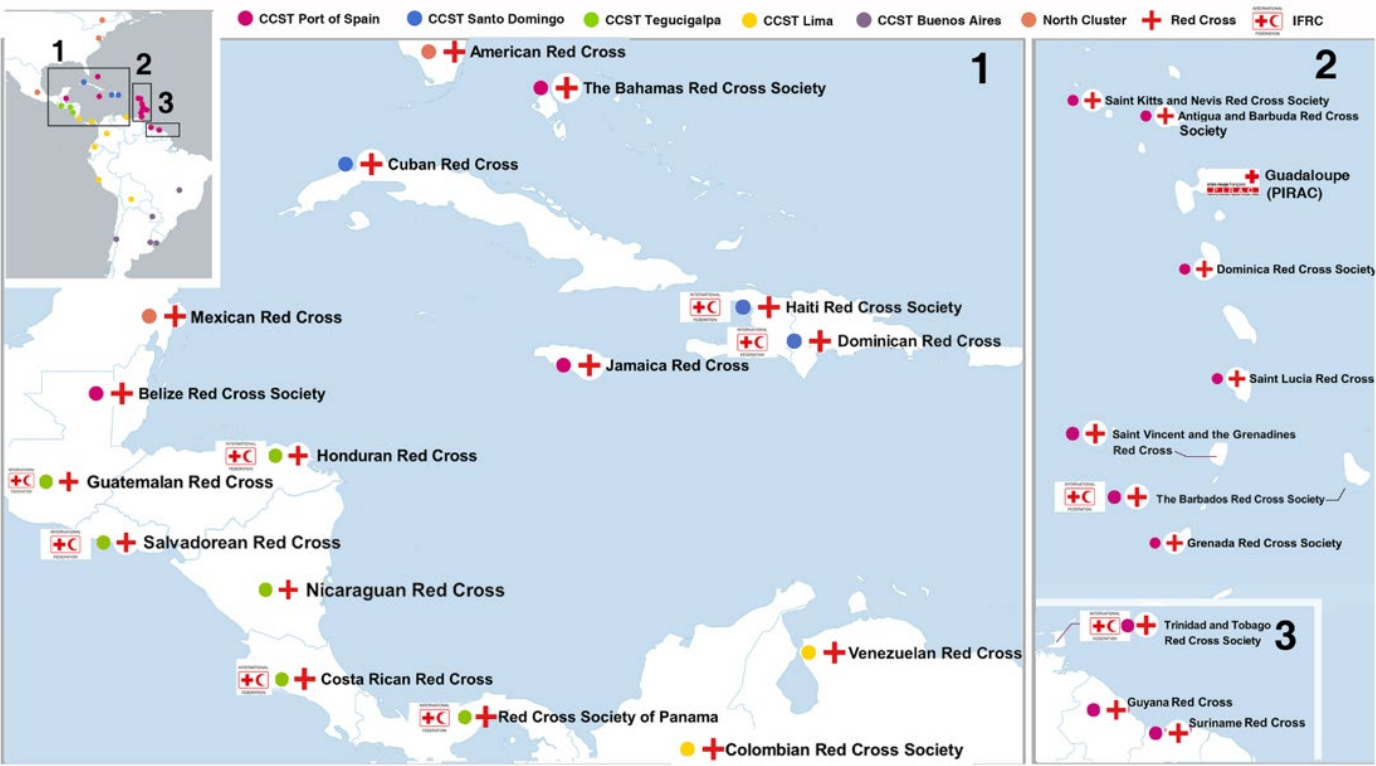


FIG. 2 **RED CROSS OVERSEAS BRANCHES IN THE CARIBBEAN REGION**

